



CHARTING THE COURSE TO COP31

Event platform: <https://hackjunction.app/hackathons/climate-hack-tion>

Background reading for Climate Hack-tion, an EU-funded hackathon for university and TAFE students across Australia, New Zealand and the Pacific, running in the lead-up to COP31.

Climate Hack-tion — online	2–4 October 2026
Pre-COP & Leaders' event — Fiji & Tuvalu	5–8 October 2026
COP31 — Antalya, Türkiye	9–20 November 2026

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How to use this library

This library has four short parts and a glossary. **Part 1** explains what COP31 actually is and why hosting looks unusual this year. **Part 2** sets out the priority areas your solution should respond to. **Part 3** covers the Pacific and Australia's role in shaping COP31. **Part 4** looks at the EU as a global climate actor and its partnership with the Pacific. The glossary defines the recurring terms along the way.

COP31 in Context

COP stands for **Conference of the Parties**: the annual meeting where countries that have signed the UN climate treaty negotiate how to act on it together. COP31 takes place in 2026, and **its hosting arrangement is the first of its kind**.

Türkiye is the formal host, holding COP31 and the World Leaders' Summit in Antalya. **Australia** takes on a separate role as President of Negotiations, leading the process of turning national positions into agreed text — an arrangement reached in partnership with **the Pacific** after Australia and Türkiye had both been competing to host the summit outright.

Before the formal summit, **Fiji hosts a Pre-COP** preparatory meeting and **Tuvalu hosts a Leaders' event**, both in the first week of October. These Pacific gatherings are designed to shape COP31's priorities in advance and put **Pacific-led solutions** in front of the world — and they follow directly on from this hackathon.

Formal host	Türkiye — Antalya Expo Center
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COP31 dates	9–20 November 2026 (Leaders' Summit 11–12 Nov)
Negotiations lead	Australia, as President of Negotiations
Pre-COP	Fiji & Tuvalu, 5–8 October 2026
Stated focus	Delivery — turning Paris Agreement commitments into practical outcomes

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[COP31 Australia–Pacific overview](#)

[dcceew.gov.au](#) — Australian Government

[COP to be hosted by Türkiye, with Australia leading negotiations](#)

[foreignminister.gov.au](#) — Australian Gov

The Priority Areas for Your Solution

Türkiye's COP31 Presidency organises its Action Agenda around **ten priority themes**, each paired with a measurable target for 2035. Climate Hack-tion asks teams to build a working solution addressing **one of five of them**.

Electrification	Raise electricity's share of global final energy demand from just over 20% today to 35% by 2035
Waste & methane	Halve the growth in global municipal solid waste by 2035
Resilient cities & buildings	Cut energy-use intensity in the building sector by at least 25% by 2035
Green industrialisation	Raise the global circular material-use rate to at least 15% by 2035
Climate awareness & education	Work toward climate action education for all by 2035

These targets aren't hackathon inventions — they're the flagship goals the COP31 Presidency launched at the Bonn Climate Change Conference in June 2026, as part of a wider Action Agenda spanning ten themes in total, from oceans and food security to health systems. The five above are the ones Climate Hack-tion has chosen as tracks for teams to build against, so a strong project should be able to point to exactly which target it answers to.

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[COP31 Presidency announces new targets on electrification, waste and resilient cities](#)

[unfccc.int](#) —  **GDSI**
Delivering Sustainable Solutions



[COP31 Action Agenda](#)

[cop31.tr](#) — COP31 Presidency, Türkiye

[Climate disinformation](#)

[climate.ec.europa.eu](#) — European Commission · useful for the awareness & education track

Australia and the Pacific

Australia and Pacific partners are running **the COP31 Pacific Partnership** together, a joint effort to put the Blue Pacific — the region's shared identity and vision for its ocean and islands — at the centre of the world's attention, and to make sure Pacific voices and Pacific-led solutions shape the negotiations rather than sit on the sidelines of them.

That leadership runs through the region's own institutions, not just around them. **The Pacific Islands Forum Chair**, its Troika of past, current and incoming chairs, and the Forum Secretariat have facilitated the decision-making that led to Fiji and Tuvalu hosting the Pre-COP and Leaders' events — a process the Pacific itself steered.

Australia's specific role is narrower but significant: as President of Negotiations, it holds authority over the negotiating process itself — preparing draft texts, choosing co-facilitators and steering the summit's final “cover decision” — a role Australia's Minister for Climate Change and Energy carries out directly.

Pacific vehicle	COP31 Pacific Partnership
Regional framing	The Blue Pacific
Facilitated by	Pacific Islands Forum Chair, Troika & Secretariat
Australia's role	President of Negotiations — drafting texts, the cover decision

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[On the Pacific journey to COP31](#)

[forumsec.org](#) — Pacific Islands Forum Secretariat

[Australia welcomes decision to host Pre-COP in Fiji and Tuvalu](#)

[foreignminister.gov.au](#) — Australian Government

The EU and Global Climate Action



Policy Dialogue and Public Diplomacy Facility for Australia



Funded by
the European Union



At home, the EU has written its own climate ambition into law. **The European Climate Law** sets climate neutrality by 2050 as a binding goal, and since April 2026 it also sets a binding intermediate target: a 90% cut in net greenhouse gas emissions by 2040, compared with 1990 levels.

The EU treats climate action as diplomacy as much as policy. Its Joint Communication on the EU's global climate and energy vision, published in October 2025, frames the clean transition as central to Europe's competitiveness and security, and **commits the EU to using multilateral engagement to convince other countries to raise their own climate ambition.** The Council's most recent conclusions on EU energy and climate diplomacy, adopted in April 2026, go further: they explicitly name the threats rising sea levels pose to low-lying states and Small Island Developing States, and commit the EU to working with the UN on risks to their sovereignty and territorial integrity — a direct line to the Pacific region this hackathon is set in.

That commitment comes with a budget. In **2024, the EU and its 27 member states contributed €31.7 billion in climate finance from public sources**, and mobilised a further €11.0 billion in private finance, to help developing countries cut emissions and adapt to climate impacts. Together with the European Investment Bank, the EU describes itself as **the world's largest collective provider of public climate finance.**

In the Pacific specifically, that cooperation has a name and a budget of its own. **Global Gateway**, the EU's international investment strategy, runs a dedicated initiative for the region — **the Green Blue Alliance for the Pacific** — bringing together the EU, its member states, the European Investment Bank and 18 Pacific countries and territories around climate action, resilience and the sustainable use of natural capital. **Team Europe has committed a minimum of €650 million to Global Gateway efforts across the Pacific**, and announced close to €300 million in new investments and budget support at the first EU–Pacific Business Forum. The EU also holds regular **High-Level Dialogues on climate directly with Australia and New Zealand**, alongside its wider engagement across the Asia-Pacific region.

The day before hacking starts, the European Commission and the European Economic and Social Committee are co-hosting a Youth Policy Dialogue on COP31 in Brussels, with the European Youth Forum and Generation Climate Europe — a reminder that **this hackathon sits inside a much larger conversation about young people's place in climate diplomacy.**

Domestic target	–90% net GHG emissions by 2040 vs. 1990 (binding since April 2026)
Long-term goal	Climate neutrality by 2050
2024 climate finance	€31.7bn public + €11.0bn private mobilised
Pacific vehicle	Global Gateway — Green Blue Alliance for the Pacific
Pacific investment	€650m+ Team Europe commitment; ~€300m package (2025)

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[Climate Action](#)

eeas.europa.eu/eas/eas-external-action-service





[The European Climate Law](#)

[climate.ec.europa.eu](#) — European Commission

[The EU at the UN Climate Change Conference](#)

[commission.europa.eu](#) — European Commission

[Council conclusions on EU energy and climate diplomacy \(2026\)](#)

[data.consilium.europa.eu](#) — Council of the European Union

[Council publishes 2024 international climate finance figures](#)

[consilium.europa.eu](#) — Council of the European Union

[Youth Policy Dialogue on COP31](#)

[eesc.europa.eu](#) — European Economic and Social Committee

GO DEEPER — EU–PACIFIC COOPERATION

[The EU and the Pacific](#)

[eeas.europa.eu](#) — European External Action Service

[EU climate cooperation with the Asia-Pacific region](#)

[climate.ec.europa.eu](#) — European Commission

[Green Blue Alliance for the Pacific](#)

[international-partnerships.ec.europa.eu](#) — European Commission

[Global Gateway: the EU to invest close to €300 million in the Pacific](#)

[eeas.europa.eu](#) — EU Delegation to Fiji

Key Terms

COP

Conference of the Parties — the yearly meeting of countries party to the UN climate treaty (the UNFCCC).

Paris Agreement

The 2015 international treaty under which countries agreed to keep global warming well below 2°C, and pursue 1.5°C.

NDC (Nationally Determined Contribution)

A country's own climate action plan and emissions target under the Paris Agreement, updated roughly every five years.

Article 6





The part of the Paris Agreement that sets rules for countries trading emissions reductions between each other, including international carbon markets.

Loss and Damage Fund

A fund, agreed at COP28, to help countries already experiencing climate impacts — like sea-level rise or extreme storms — cope with harm that adaptation couldn't prevent.

COP31 Action Agenda

The set of non-negotiated initiatives, targets and partnerships a COP Presidency uses to drive action alongside the formal negotiations — including the ten priority themes and 2035 targets behind this hackathon's tracks.

The Blue Pacific

The Pacific Islands Forum's shared framing of the region as one ocean continent, used to present a unified Pacific voice in forums like COP31.

European Climate Law EU

The EU regulation that makes climate neutrality by 2050, and an intermediate 90% emissions cut by 2040, legally binding across all member states.

Source: climate.ec.europa.eu

Global Gateway EU

The EU's strategy for financing infrastructure and sustainable development abroad, including the Green Blue Alliance for the Pacific.

Source: eeas.europa.eu

Team Europe EU

The EU, its member states, and European financial institutions such as the European Investment Bank acting together on a shared initiative — the format behind the EU's Pacific climate commitments.

Source: eeas.europa.eu

International climate finance EU

Money richer countries provide or mobilise to help developing countries cut emissions and adapt to climate change. The EU and its member states contributed €31.7 billion in public climate finance in 2024, plus €11.0 billion in mobilised private finance.

Source: consilium.europa.eu

THANK YOU FOR JOINING CLIMATE HACK-TION!

